

Zucchini Biscuits (Parmesan Herb)



4.8 from 358 reviews

Author: Sally McKenney **Prep Time:** 20 minutes **Cook Time:** 20 minutes

Total Time: 40 minutes **Yield:** 12 biscuits

These zucchini drop biscuits are filled with vibrant flavors like basil, parsley, parmesan, garlic, and black pepper, and they're ready in just 40 minutes. Be sure to drain and wring out moisture from the shredded zucchini as instructed in step 2. See recipe Notes for more flavor ideas and freezing instructions.

Ingredients

- 1 and 1/4 cups (150g) shredded **zucchini**
- 1 teaspoon **salt**, divided
- 2 and 1/2 cups (313g) **all-purpose flour** (spooned & leveled), plus more as needed
- 2 teaspoons **baking powder**
- 1/2 teaspoon **baking soda**
- 3/4 teaspoon **garlic powder** (or 2 cloves minced garlic)
- 1/4 teaspoon freshly **ground black pepper**
- 3/4 cup (60g) freshly **grated parmesan cheese**
- 1/2 cup (8 Tbsp; 113g) **unsalted butter**, cold & cubed
- 2 Tablespoons chopped **fresh basil** (or 1 and 1/2 teaspoons dried)
- 1 Tablespoon chopped **fresh parsley** (or 1 teaspoon dried)
- 1 cup (240ml) **buttermilk***, cold, plus 2 Tablespoons for brushing on top
- **optional**, for topping: flaky sea salt

Instructions

- 1 Preheat oven to 425°F (218°C). Line two large baking sheets with parchment paper or silicone baking mats. Set aside.
- 2 **Drain the zucchini:** Line a colander or large bowl with a few paper towels or a clean, thin kitchen towel. (You can also use cheesecloth for this step.) Place the shredded zucchini inside. Add 1/2 teaspoon salt, and gently mix together. Top with another paper towel and press down so the towels begin absorbing some liquid. Let sit for 10 minutes. Lift everything up using the bottom towel and, over the sink, wring/squeeze out as much liquid as you can. The goal is to remove as much moisture from the zucchini as possible. Give your hands a break if needed, then return to squeezing out more liquid. You will be amazed how much liquid you wring out! You'll have about 1/2 cup of shredded zucchini to use in the dough. A little more or less is fine.

- 3 **Make the biscuits:** Place the flour, remaining 1/2 teaspoon salt, baking powder, baking soda, garlic powder, pepper, and parmesan cheese together in a large bowl or in a large food processor. Whisk or pulse until combined. Add the cubed butter and cut into the dry ingredients with a [pastry cutter](#) or 2 forks, or by pulsing several times in the processor. Cut/pulse until coarse crumbs form. Do not over-mix. If you used a food processor, pour the mixture into a large bowl.
- 4 Fold in the basil, parsley, and zucchini. Make a well in the center of the mixture. Pour 1 cup (240ml) buttermilk on top. Fold everything together with a large spoon or spatula until it comes together in one shaggy-looking ball. Avoid overworking the dough as best you can. Add a sprinkle of flour if dough seems too wet.
- 5 Divide the dough into 12 equal portions, about 4 Tablespoons of dough each. If you want to be precise, each should weigh about 65 grams. Shape into a ball as best you can and arrange 6 biscuits on each prepared baking sheet. Brush each evenly with remaining buttermilk. If desired, sprinkle each lightly with flaky sea salt.
- 6 Bake for 19–21 minutes or until the tops are golden brown. For a more accurate test, the biscuits are done when an [instant-read thermometer](#) inserted into the center registers 195–200°F (90–93°C).
- 7 Remove from the oven and enjoy warm. Cover leftovers tightly and store at room temperature or in the refrigerator for up to 5 days.

Notes

- 1 **Make Ahead & Freezing Instructions:** Baked biscuits freeze well for up to 3 months. Thaw at room temperature or in the refrigerator, then warm up to your liking before serving. You can also freeze the biscuit dough. Prepare the dough in steps 2 through 4. Wrap tightly in plastic wrap (plastic wrap is best for freshness), place in a freezer-safe container or zip-top bag, and freeze for up to 3 months. Thaw overnight in the refrigerator, then continue with step 5. Also, after step 4, you can wrap the dough in plastic wrap and refrigerate for up to 2 days before continuing with step 5.
- 2 **Special Tools** (affiliate links): [Box Grater](#) | [Colander](#) | [Glass Mixing Bowls](#) | [Whisk](#) | [Pastry Cutter](#) or [Food Processor](#) | [Baking Sheet](#) | [Silicone Baking Mat](#) or [Parchment Paper](#) | [Pastry Brush](#) | [Flaky Sea Salt](#)
- 3 **Can I Bake These in a Cast Iron Skillet?** Absolutely. In fact, that's how I first tested the recipe. Gently shape into balls as the recipe instructs, then arrange in a greased 10-inch cast iron skillet (or any 10-inch oven-safe skillet). The bake time is closer to 23–24 minutes.
- 4 **Can I Use Yellow Squash Instead of Zucchini?** Absolutely; use the same amount. You'll still want to drain/squeeze out the moisture as the recipe instructs.
- 5 **Other Cheeses:** I prefer parmesan for its salty, nutty, and robust flavor. Feel free to swap for another hard or medium-hard cheese you can shred such as cheddar, pecorino romano, pepper jack, smoked gouda, asiago, or a combo of any of these totaling 3/4 cup. I would avoid super-soft cheeses like goat cheese. Feta cheese would likely be OK!

- 6 **Cold Ingredients in Dough:** Make sure the butter and buttermilk are SUPER cold. Cold ingredients, as well as chilling, help the crust keep its shape.
- 7 **Buttermilk:** Buttermilk adds unbelievable flavor and texture to this dough. If you don't have buttermilk, use this [DIY buttermilk substitute](#) instead. Add 2 teaspoons of fresh lemon juice or white vinegar to a liquid measuring cup. Then add enough cold whole milk until it reaches 1 cup (240ml). Stir together and let it sit for 5 minutes before using in the recipe.
- 8 **Other Flavor Ideas:** Feel free to swap out the basil and parsley, or leave them in, and use some fresh dill or thyme, a couple Tablespoons of chopped chives, a few slices of cooked bacon (chopped), a sprinkle of red pepper flakes, or the zest of a lemon. Have fun with different flavors.

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